

61.6

Written by
Daniel Jenkins

385-335-0327
thecybergrape@gmail.com

INT. RADIO STATION - LOADING DOCK - NIGHT

Pitch black. Everything is quiet except for a mild wind blowing past the building and the pitter-patter of a light drizzle beginning to fall.

A loud METALLIC CREAK pierces the air. Light spills in as a heavy-duty garage door grinds open.

IVY MERCER, 25, wearing a jacket and a small backpack, holds up her phone and tentatively steps into the cavernous space.

Outside, the rain intensifies into a downpour. Ivy moves deeper into the abandoned facility, pointing her camera at every panel.

IVY

And we're in, folks. I told you I'd find it. And with time to spare, too.

She speaks into the phone, keeping an eye on the CHAT of her livestream. She has only 7 viewers.

CHAT (ON SCREEN)

• Click here for a free phone! ->

She gives a wry grimace but presses on. The storm is raging now. Ivy pulls the metal door shut behind her with another METALLIC SCREECH. Too dark to see, she switches on her phone's flashlight and heads for the next hall, narrating to her audience.

INT. HALLWAY - CONTINUOUS

IVY

Welcome to the home of Euclidean Rock Radio, FM 61.6! You may remember the name from the news. The infamous events that took place here are still talked about in true crime circles to this day.

A CRACK of lightning illuminates the dilapidated hall for a split second. Broken glass. Crumbling concrete. It's a pitiful sight. The walls bear the remnants of song lyrics painted long ago, now mostly peeled away. Ivy tenses slightly, but her voice carries on, unaffected.

IVY (CONT'D)

When such a grisly event occurs, it's common for rumors and theories to emerge. Our way of coping with tragedy? Perhaps. Or maybe there's more to it... an unnatural force lending its energy to help us understand. Legend has it, if you come here at midnight and tune a radio to station 666, you can hear the voices of Hell. Millions of poor souls trapped in eternal suffering, desperate to be heard...

A small DING from her phone. A notification pops up, complete with a little firework animation: "NEW MILESTONE! 50 VIEWERS." She smiles and gets back to the content as more chat messages roll in.

CHAT (ON SCREEN)

- Is this the station up on the hill? I heard its dangerous
- I love urban exploration!
- What's going on?

INT. CONTROL ROOM - CONTINUOUS

Ivy rounds the corner into a large space. A huge center console dominates the room, covered in dials, switches, and a thick layer of dust.

IVY

The heart of the beast. We're in the brains of the building, everyone. This is where the magic happened.

She takes her time moving through the space, running her hands over the rusty machinery and crumbling chairs, sweeping her phone across all of it to immerse her growing audience. She's deep enough inside now that the storm is more comforting ambience than distraction.

On the far wall is a row of levers and switches. One is labeled "EMERGENCY POWER." Ivy walks over, keeping the show going.

IVY (CONT'D)

Fifty-one. That's how many people went missing that fateful November night.

(MORE)

IVY (CONT'D)

Normally, a station this size would never have employed so many people, but they were part of a corporate cluster. Two frequencies under one roof.

Another flash of lightning spills in through the doorways.

IVY (CONT'D)

No trace of them was ever found. No bodies, no blood, not even a note. Nobody made or received a phone call. Everything seemed normal... until the broadcast went dead at 6 p.m. exactly.

Ivy grips the heavy switch and pulls it down with a satisfying THUNK. A few seconds later, some of the overhead lights flicker on, restoring at least some auxiliary power.

Across the room, a heavy rack-mounted machine with two oversized reels -- a 1990s REEL-TO-REEL LOGGING RECORDER -- groans to life. Its small VU meters glow a faint, dusty amber. The reels spin backward for a second, rewinding automatically, then stop with a loud mechanical CLACK.

Ivy blinks, tracking the sound, and pans her camera over to the machine. The digital counter on the deck reads: "17:58:40 -- NOVEMBER 14, 1994."

IVY (CONT'D)

Oh, wow. Guys, look at this. This is an FCC logger. It recorded everything broadcast that night. The police allegedly released transcripts, but the actual tape was lost in evidence.

She approaches the deck. One button is caked in grime, but still labeled: PLAY. She hesitates, then presses it.

The reels spin. Thick analog static fills the room from the console speakers, followed by the crisp sound of a '90s rock track.

IVY (CONT'D)

(whispering to her
phone)

Just over a minute before the
blackout.

On the tape, the song abruptly cuts out. A heavy, rhythmic METALLIC THUD echoes -- like a garage door slamming shut.

ON-AIR DJ (V.O.)
(through speakers,
confused)
The hell was that? Troy? Is the
back bay door acting up again?

In the background of the recording, distant, overlapping voices begin to rise from the office hallways. Not screams of pain -- murmurs of mass confusion. Dozens of people.

ON-AIR DJ (V.O.) (CONT'D)
Uh, folks, having some technical
difficulties here in the studio.
Gonna throw it to a commercial
break--

The DJ's voice cuts off as he drops his headset. The open studio mic catches his footsteps running to the studio door. He opens it.

Hallway noise floods the tape. A cacophony of fifty people gasping, whispering -- then suddenly moving in unison. A massive, low-frequency HUM, like a vacuum tearing open, vibrates through the speakers.

Then a sudden, collective INHALATION from every single person in the building. One unified gasp.

The digital counter hits 18:00:00.

Absolute, dead silence. The reels keep spinning, but the tape is completely blank. Dead air.

Ivy stares at the spinning reels, completely unnerved.

- CHAT (ON SCREEN)
- what happened to them?
 - I remember this, it was talked about for weeks
 - knew someone from school who was related to one of the missing employees, haven't talked with them in ages
 - probably a mass suicide, like some of those old cults

Ivy makes her way to the center console and checks the chat log and the viewer count. She's up to 120.

IVY
A full profile was made on every
person who disappeared.
(MORE)

IVY (CONT'D)
Psychological state, personal history, anything the detectives could gather. If this was planned, there was no evidence of it.

Ivy sits down in the center chair and props up her phone to face her, then pulls off her backpack. From it, she takes a small portable FM radio and shows it to her ever-growing audience. The clock on her phone reads 11:58.

IVY (CONT'D)
And here we are! In just a minute, we'll tune this radio and see if the legend holds any weight. What do you guys think is going to happen?

CHAT (ON SCREEN)

- nothing
- nothing
- you might pick up a trucker?
- wait don't you need a permit to be in there ?
- static

The stream is gaining traction. The view count keeps climbing. 198... 199... 201.

It's now midnight.

IVY
Perfect timing! Welcome, everyone, to the stream! It just hit twelve, and we're about to see for certain what happens when we tune this radio to FM 666... Are you guys ready?

The chat is rolling faster now, harder to read, but a few repeated messages stand out.

CHAT (ON SCREEN)

- YES!
- so ready
- i'm covering my eyes!

Ivy turns on the radio and slowly turns the dial, passing a few stations on the way. The view count ticks up with each click. Songs morph together, news and weather cut in and out, until she finally lands on 666.

Static. No discernible signal. For half a minute, nothing happens.

CHAT (ON SCREEN)

- nothing, .
- anti climatic
- can i open my eyes?

IVY

It may seem like nothing, but if we
listen a little closer...

Off camera, Ivy slips a small FM transmitter out of her backpack, wired to an MP3 player. Its screen lists audio files: "creepy_ambience001.mp3," "whispers-08.mp3," "ghostly_voice.wav," and more. The transmitter is set to 66.6. She selects a file and hits play.

Still static. Ivy starts and stops the file a few times, but the radio produces nothing. She turns it over in her hands.

IVY (CONT'D)

(under her breath)

What's the matter with you...

She cranks the volume all the way up, smacks the radio a couple of times, and readjusts the tuning. Nothing works. Even the stations she passed earlier are gone. There's no signal here at all.

Ivy looks around in a mild panic, then quickly composes herself as her eyes land on a banner on the wall bearing the station's original frequency. She turns back to her phone.

IVY (CONT'D)

Now, of course I expected that not
to work. Did no one ever stop and
think that the real evil number to
tune to would be the one the
station actually used?

Ivy tunes the radio again -- this time to 61.6.

The moment the dial lands on the station, the radio EXPLODES with noise. Ivy screams, drops it on the table, and stumbles backward in fright. From the little radio pours an endless stream of suffering -- wailing, crying, screaming from a trillion tortured souls, far louder than such a small box should be able to produce.

Ivy covers her ears and waits a beat. She reaches over to turn the radio off, but the switch doesn't work. The volume dial does nothing either, and the tuning dial won't budge. It's stuck in place. She goes to open the battery compartment when the noise suddenly stops.

Ivy hesitates over the now-silent box. Then a voice emerges. It's unintelligible, but unmistakably speech -- distorted, deep, forceful, and slow. Whatever language it is, it's not of this world.

The voice speaks uninterrupted for thirty seconds, then ends abruptly. The radio returns to static, and Ivy is finally able to switch it off.

She drops the radio on the floor and just stands there in shock, eyes wide.

A beat.

She composes herself, breathes, then turns back to her phone. The chat is going nuts.

CHAT (ON SCREEN)

- OH MY GOD
- what was that??
- fake
- It was speaking directly to me!
- yea, i heard my name,...
- wait did it speak to all of us?

IVY

Well, everyone, someone's clearly broadcasting some creepy audio on 61.6... Wait, could you guys understand that? It sounded like gibberish to me...

CHAT (ON SCREEN)

- yes
- ya
- it was rly clr 2 me
- i understood

Ivy stares at the chat log. A flood of "yes"es confirms that most of them understood it. She furrows her brow and notices the view count approaching 500.

IVY

Okay... what did it say?

The chat slows a bit, but a few messages come in with a similar pattern.

CHAT (ON SCREEN)

- it told me i was responsible for my brothers death..
- to me it was just berating me over and over

(MORE)

CHAT (ON SCREEN) (CONT'D)

- the voice tried to make me feel guilty
- i got a date for my death? Like 4 years from now, what does that mean? Do i believe it?
- i think you're dying in 4 years, man
- to me, it said something about 'going through the red door'
- same here, i should go through a red door, but there's no red doors in my house
- yea, me too. Red door
- 'go through the red door', also it hates me :(

IVY

(whispering to herself)

Red door...

Then Ivy notices how quiet it is. The storm has stopped. The entire station is silent, except for her heavy breathing.

IVY (CONT'D)

Um, thank you all for coming to the stream. It's late, and, uh, I'll be back on tomorrow afternoon, and...

CHAT (ON SCREEN)

- booo!
- you cant stop!
- look for a red door
- don't end it yet!
- were too invested now, keep going

Ivy quickly gathers the radio and the transmitter and stuffs them into her pack. Everything in hand, she heads for the exit -- when her phone DINGS again: "NEW MILESTONE! 750 VIEWERS."

Her thumb hovers over "END STREAM" for a beat. She doesn't press it. She keeps moving.

IVY

I don't know how that tape ended up back here, but it's potentially new evidence. Assuming it's not planted as a prank... super elaborate, if you ask me.

INT. HALLWAY - CONTINUOUS

Ivy leaves the control room and heads down the hallway toward the loading dock. The hall is well lit now. Outside, it's too dark to see -- the windows are pitch black.

The view count continues to grow. Ivy walks for a long time beneath the flickering lights.

Almost a full minute of walking. Ivy slows to a stop and stares intensely down the rest of the hallway. She turns and looks back the way she came. The control room entrance is only about fifty feet behind her. Not a minute's walk.

IVY

I must be more tired than I
thought. This hall seems bigger
now, ha-ha.

She starts walking again, deliberately placing each step.

CHAT (ON SCREEN)

- this is a long hallway, .
- old buildings are like that,
they're intentionally designed as
optical illusions.
- what station needs this much
space?

Ivy keeps walking. And walking. Her breathing quickens, and she picks up speed -- faster and faster, until she's sprinting. She starts to cry softly. The hallway isn't getting any shorter.

The flickering grows more intense, plunging the hall into darkness for longer and longer stretches. From the shadows along the wall, what looks like a HUMAN ARM lashes out of nowhere and knocks Ivy to the floor mid-sprint.

On the ground, Ivy whips around to see what hit her. The lights flicker back on: a hanging sign protrudes from the wall, swinging back and forth as if someone had just run into it. Ivy wipes the tears from her face and reads it: "<-
LOADING DOCK."

She looks to her left and sees the doorway to the loading dock. She quickly gets up, grabs her phone, and heads through it.

INT. LOADING DOCK - CONTINUOUS

Ivy spots the large metal door she came in through and starts toward it. As she gets closer, a flickering light on an adjacent wall catches her attention.

It illuminates a simple wooden door beneath it, the kind you'd find in a bedroom. It's painted a deep crimson. If it was there before, she didn't notice it.

Ivy stares at the door, unable to move. She manages a single step toward the exit when her phone DINGS again:
"CONGRATULATIONS! YOU'VE HIT 1,000 CONCURRENT VIEWERS."

CHAT (ON SCREEN)

- It's the door!
- I can feel it through the screen, you need to go to the door
- What if all those people are trapped?? You should see if you can free them!
- everyone who wants to see her go through the door put a thumbs up

The chat fills with a stream of thumbs-up emojis, and the view count keeps rising. Ivy looks around nervously, steadies her breathing, and addresses the stream.

IVY

So... do you want to see behind the door?

The chat accelerates.

CHAT (ON SCREEN)

- YES!
- Absolutely
- yesyesyesyesyes
- i'm so excited, yes!

She holds a shaky smile and heads for the door. The frame sits several inches off the ground and cuts right through an old sign on the wall.

IVY

The contractors certainly didn't pay much mind to the surrounding wall. Ha-ha.

Her forced laugh catches, and she clears her throat.

CHAT (ON SCREEN)

- haha
- true lol
- xD funny!

Ivy glances back at the exit, then turns to the red door and takes a deep breath. She reaches for the handle and turns it slowly. The door swings open effortlessly with a CREAK, revealing a dark wooden staircase leading down.

View count: 1,500.

INT. BASEMENT - CONTINUOUS

The chat explodes with intrigue. Ivy carefully steps onto the first stair. It groans and settles under her weight. So does the second. And every one after, all the way down.

At the bottom, Ivy sweeps her light around. She's in an impossibly large space. Her light can't reach a single wall -- just a concrete floor and ceiling stretching into infinite darkness.

View count: 2,000. A warning pops up on her phone: "LOW BATTERY."

IVY
(to herself)
What the...

Ivy takes a step back toward the staircase -- and her hearing goes out.

She doubles over in pain, jaw hanging open, hands gripping her head. A faint RINGING. Her ears POP, and slowly her hearing returns. She looks back up the staircase.

The door is gone.

Ivy races up the stairs. At the top, there's nothing but a concrete wall. She pounds on it with her fists and yells.

IVY (CONT'D)
HELP! Someone, please! LET ME OUT!

The wall is solid. Slightly moist. Ivy glances down at her phone: 3,000 viewers. She quickly dials 911.

911 DISPATCH (V.O.)
911, what's your emergency?

IVY
Hello! I'm Ivy Mercer. Uh, I'm trapped and I need help. Please come to the abandoned radio station at the top of the hill as soon as you can!

911 DISPATCH (V.O.)
The old Euclidean station? I'll
send a team right away. Where are
you exactly?

IVY
Thank you! Near the loading dock
entrance, there's a red door off to
the side! I walked in, and now it's
gone.

911 DISPATCH (V.O.)
Okay. What are you doing there?

IVY
I'm a streamer. Uh, this was just
an urban exploration of an old
creepy building, that's all.
Please, let me--

The dispatcher cuts her off, voice suddenly cold.

911 DISPATCH (V.O.)
You stupid girl.

IVY
...I'm sorry?

911 DISPATCH (V.O.)
I hate that I have to waste my
breath on you. Here's what you're
going to do. You are going to go
back down those stairs, and walk.

IVY
(quietly)
How do you know about the...
(beat)
How long do I walk for?

911 DISPATCH (V.O.)
Until you can't anymore.

Dial tone. They hang up, leaving Ivy in shock. She dials
again.

911 DISPATCH (V.O.)
911, what's your emergency?

IVY
Um, hello? I think our call
might've been cut off, and--

911 DISPATCH (V.O.)
The old Euclidean station? I'll
send a team right away. Where are
you exactly?

IVY
Huh? Hold on, that's not what I
said. Please listen, I--

911 DISPATCH (V.O.)
Okay. What are you doing there?

Same voice. Same cadence. Ivy's lip trembles, but she
doesn't say a word.

911 DISPATCH (V.O.) (CONT'D)
You stupid girl. I hate that I have
to waste my breath on you. Here's
what you're going to do. You are
going to--

Ivy hangs up. She reopens the stream: 5,000 viewers.

She walks back down the stairs and ventures into the
darkness, each step slow and hesitant.

She walks for some time. Visibly sweating, Ivy peels off her
jacket and leaves it behind as she keeps going. A stench
hits her. She covers her nose and grimaces.

Ivy's boot steps forward -- and sinks. The sharp CLACK of
concrete is replaced by a wet, sickening SQUELCH. She aims
her phone's flashlight down.

The floor is gone. She's standing on a landscape of raw,
pulsing flesh.

She stops and lets out a quiet sob, staring into the
nothingness ahead. Her phone DINGS.

1,000,000 viewers and counting. The number keeps spinning
upward in a blur. The chat is going insane, but every
message says the same thing.

CHAT (ON SCREEN)

- keep going
- keep going
- keep going
- keep going

Over and over. Ivy breaks down crying at the sight.

The radio in her bag ERUPTS with noise. Ivy pulls it out.
She can barely make out the words.

RADIO (V.O.)
--you don't know the agony--
--we were cursed to be forever
without a body--

Ivy screams and throws the radio. She falls backward into the flesh with a disgusting, squishy SLAP. Somewhere in the darkness, the radio lands with a SPLASH.

Ivy lifts her phone and points it forward. View count:
10,000,000.

The livestream feed turns to static for a beat. Then a facial-detection square locks onto a seemingly empty patch of the void. Ivy looks up from the phone but can't make anything out.

Another square. Another face detected. Then another. Twenty pop up at once. A warning flashes: "TOO MANY SUBJECTS."

Out of the abyss emerges a demonic silhouette, cloaked in shadow.

Then everything goes dark. A dead battery icon flashes on the screen, and her light fades out.

In total darkness, squishy footsteps approach Ivy. A voice speaks to her, directly.

LEGION
Give us yours.

CUT TO BLACK.

THE END